

Refining Paths Quick Reference

FDD 4.4 · DIGITAL COMMUNICATIONS

NAME _____

DATE _____



Simplify

Object > Path > Simplify:
reduces anchor points on a
messy path while keeping its
shape.



Join

Cmd/Ctrl+J: connects two
selected open endpoints into
one point, or closes an open
path.



Shape Builder Tool

Shift+M: drag across
overlapping shapes to merge
them. Option/Alt-click a region
to remove it.



Pathfinder: Unite

Combines all selected shapes
into one single shape.



Pathfinder: Minus Front

Subtracts the top shape(s)
from the shape behind them.



Offset Path

Object > Path > Offset Path:
creates a new outline a set
distance inside or outside a
shape.

Two-Minute Drill (today's F3): when your teacher says
go, take the low-poly facet you're working on and use
one of the tools above to clean it up. Screenshot the
before and after.